Saturday 24 October 2026, SLB Championship

London Lions *v* Bristol Flyers

18:00

Copper Box Arena, Queen Elizabeth Olympic Park, London E20 3HB

Six from six in the league and back from Romania, the Lions host the one side that has come within two of them. Bristol sit second, have won four of their last five, and lost to London by two in September on a missed open jumper.

Sources: SLB standings, 22 Oct, Club report, 18 Sep, Bristol summary (Genius Sports)

Form *6–0 in the SLB, 2–2 in Europe*

Four games in ten days end on Saturday. The Lions beat Cheshire 87–83 on Sunday with a 10–0 run to close the first half and Joel Scott's free throws with 13 seconds left, then held U-BT Cluj to 72 points on Wednesday after a 40–37 half-time lead. "Our defence, 72 points is crazy," said head coach Tautvydas Sabonis.

Wed 21 Oct *EuroCup* at U-BT Cluj-Napoca	W 89–72
Sun 18 Oct *SLB* at Cheshire Phoenix	W 87–83
Thu 15 Oct *EuroCup* v Skyliners Frankfurt	L 76–81
Tue 6 Oct *EuroCup* v La Laguna Tenerife	W 89–77
Fri 2 Oct *SLB* v Leicester Riders	W 71–66
Wed 30 Sep *EuroCup* at Siauliai	L 71–74
Sun 27 Sep *SLB* v Liverpool Basketball	W 78–49
Wed 23 Sep *SLB* v Cheshire Phoenix	W 91–81
Sun 20 Sep *SLB* v Newcastle Eagles	W 84–76
Fri 18 Sep *SLB* at Bristol Flyers	W 80–78

Sources: Club report, 21 Oct, Club report, 18 Oct, Genius Sports fixtures, EuroLeague API

Lions roster *and who to watch*

Thomas Kennedy

11.5 pts, 4.7 reb, 60.9% from the field

Leads the Lions in scoring and has not taken a three. Went 7 of 7 inside at Cluj on Wednesday.

Joel Scott

10.4 pts, 4.8 reb in 22 minutes

Scored the late baskets and both closing free throws at Cheshire; 15 points and five rebounds at Cluj.

Landrius Horton

9.8 pts, 43.5% from three on 23 attempts

Led the Lions with 16 at Bristol in September, including the three that tied the game late. 4 of 5 from deep at Cheshire.

Devante Jones

9.4 pts, 3.6 ast, 90% from the line

Converted both free throws with 18.8 seconds left to beat Bristol in September.

Full roster

1	Joel Scott	C/F
2	Maxwell Lewis III	F
3	Devante Jones	G
5	Ade Adebayo	F
6	Morayo Soluade	F
7	Joshua O’Garro	F
8	Emilis Zibuda	F
10	Ethan Price	C/F
12	Keenan Evans	G
21	Aaryn Rai	F
22	Tarik Phillip	G

23	Landrius Horton	F/G
31	Deane Williams	C/F
54	Thomas Kennedy	C

Sources: Lions stats (Genius Sports), Lions roster (Genius Sports), Club report, 21 Oct, Club report, 18 Oct, Club report, 18 Sep

Club news

Saily, the travel eSIM app, moved up to principal partner on 14 October, its third season with the club. The NextGen team play the Adidas Next Generation Tournament pre-qualifier in Vienna. The club's 13 October report covers the Lions' game against the Portland Trail Blazers.

Sources: Club news, 14 Oct, Club news, 13 Oct, Club news

Bristol Flyers *second, 4–2*

Andreas Kapoulas's side have won four of five in the league since losing here, including 90–89 over Liverpool last Sunday when Davion Bailey's left-handed lay-in with 16 seconds left stood up after two missed free throws at the other end. In between they went to Germany in the ENBL and lost 106–84 at Syntainics MBC. They have had six days off; the Lions have had three.

They shoot threes, nearly 30 a game: Bailey takes more than seven, Zach Anderson more than six, and Diggins and Jennings nearly five each. Holden runs the offence and rebounds like a forward, but gives the ball away 3.3 times a game.

Davion Bailey

18.3 pts, 7.3 three-point attempts a game

The Flyers' scorer. 17 points, six assists and three steals against Liverpool last Sunday. Missed the open jumper that would have beaten London in September.

Michael Diggins Jr

12.2 pts, 5.5 reb, 2.0 blocks

The 2.07 m forward who protects the rim and takes nearly five threes a game.

Cameron Holden

9.2 pts, 6.5 reb, 4.5 ast

The point guard. Leads the team in assists and rebounds but also averages 3.3 turnovers.

Matteus Case

10.0 pts in 14 minutes, 56.8% from the field

Scoring off the bench at a rate nobody else on either roster matches.

Last five

Sun 18 Oct *SLB* v Liverpool Basketball	W 90–89
Mid-Oct *ENBL* at Syntainics MBC (Germany)	L 84–106
Fri 9 Oct *SLB* at Leicester Riders	W 78–73
Fri 2 Oct *SLB* v Manchester Basketball	W 76–58
Fri 25 Sep *SLB* at Newcastle Eagles	L 68–94

Full roster

0	Cameron Holden	G
1	Zac Triplett	G
2	Michael Diggins Jr	F
4	Matteus Case	G
5	Davion Bailey	G
9	Dylan Wilkie	G
10	Zachary Anderson	F

13	Kasen Jennings	G
21	Marcus Delpeche	C/F
22	Malcolm Delpeche	C
24	Imam Toure	F
25	Milos Dugalic	F
99	Nojus Zajankauskas	G

Sources: Bristol summary (Genius Sports), Bristol stats (Genius Sports), Bristol roster (Genius Sports), Flyers report, 18 Oct, Flyers men's news

Things to watch

- **Inside against outside.** Kennedy and Scott score almost entirely at the rim; Bristol take nearly 30 threes a game. Whichever shot falls decides it.
- **Bristol's turnovers.** Holden averages 3.3 and Jennings 2.2. Five Lions average more than a steal a game, and London took the ball off Cluj on an inbound on Wednesday.
- **The free-throw line.** September was decided there. Jones is 9 of 10 this season, Evans 18 of 21; Tarik Phillip is 5 of 14.
- **Legs.** London played in Romania on Wednesday. Bristol last played on Sunday.

Sources: Lions stats (Genius Sports), Bristol stats (Genius Sports), Club report, 18 Sep, Club report, 21 Oct

Head to head *four Lions wins, three by*

seven or fewer

18 Sep 2026 *SLB* at Bristol	Lions 80–78
10 Apr 2026 *SLB* at Bristol	Lions 83–76
27 Mar 2026 *SLB* Copper Box	Lions 77–57
4 Jan 2026 *SLB Trophy* at Bristol	Lions 77–76

September: Bristol led 18–17 after a quarter, London by 14 in the second, tied at 47 in the third, and Holden's free throws put the Flyers 78–75 up before Horton's three and Jones's two from the line.

Sources: Club schedule, Club report, 18 Sep

SLB table

	Team	P	W	L	Pts
1	**London Lions**	**6**	**6**	**0**	**12**
2	**Bristol Flyers**	**6**	**4**	**2**	**8**
3	Caledonia Gladiators	5	3	2	6
4	Newcastle Eagles	5	3	2	6
5	B. Braun Sheffield Sharks	4	2	2	4
6	Cheshire Phoenix	5	2	3	4
7	Liverpool Basketball	5	2	3	4
8	Manchester Basketball	6	2	4	4
9	Surrey 89ers	3	1	2	2
10	Leicester Riders	5	0	5	0

Sources: SLB standings, 22 Oct

Notable

- Kennedy has made 28 of 46 shots in the league and attempted no threes.
- Bailey's 110 points are 37 more than any Bristol team-mate.
- The Lions' smallest winning margin this season is two, at Bristol.

Sources: Lions stats (Genius Sports), Bristol stats (Genius Sports), Genius Sports fixtures

Watch

- Lions handle business in Cluj (highlights, 21 Oct)
- Lions edge Cheshire 87–83 (highlights, 18 Oct)
- Flyers 90–89 Liverpool (highlights, 18 Oct)

Sources: Lions YouTube feed, Flyers men's news

What's next

Wed 28 Oct, 19:30	*EuroCup* v Turk Telekom Ankara, Copper Box
Fri 30 Oct, 19:00	*SLB* at B. Braun Sheffield Sharks
Wed 4 Nov, 19:30	*EuroCup* at Maxima Roma (the club page says 20:00; the EuroLeague API says 19:30 UK and wins)
Fri 6 Nov, 19:00	*SLB* at Leicester Riders

Sources: Club schedule, EuroLeague API, Genius Sports fixtures